



Clean your glasses

A Swiss startup Cliris SA has developed a new automatic eyewear cleaner
<http://dgit.in/ClirisCleaner>



Building lighter airplanes

New material developed which is lighter than aerogel and 10,000 times stronger, could be used in airplanes and motor cars <http://dgit.in/StrongBuildingMaterial>

HOW WE TESTED

Initial setup: All Ultrabooks to be tested are first examined and any and everything about them is catalogued, including bundled software, accessories, etc. We then completely wipe all data on the Ultrabooks and install a copy of the Windows 8.1 Enterprise Edition. Drivers and essential software are installed from the manufacturers' website before running Windows update. Finally, the devices are set to run in performance mode in the BIOS as well as in the power options.

Performance tests: We conduct a whole series of tests on the devices to measure the

impact of every aspect of the system on overall performance. These tests include Cinebench, POV-Ray, PCMark8, 3DMark, and many more. We use PCMark8's Creative test suite to evaluate battery life. Results are carefully catalogued.

Screen contrast ratio is measured using the Spyder3 Elite test unit and lagom.nl.

The final performance score is the weighted sum of all the scores catalogued. Weights are assigned based on the perceived importance of the components.

Features score: The features present in each Ultrabook are tabulated and given weighted

scores depending on perceived importance. For example, dedicated multimedia keys and volume keys are given more weightage than those that are shared with Fn keys.

Design and Usability: The scores for this parameter are largely subjective as they indicate our experience with the device. Items such as quality of the keyboard, responsiveness of the touch-screen, etc. are weighted and scored.

Final score: The final score that we arrive at is the sum of the performance, features and design scores with a 40%, 30% and 30% breakup respectively.

Understanding winners:

The Best Buy laptop is awarded to the device with the best price to performance ratio based on a pre-determined formula. This is the ideal, value for money product in the test.

The Best Performer award is awarded to the device with the highest overall performance score.

The Editor's Pick award is awarded to the device that we feel has a lot of promise but misses out on the previous two awards narrowly. The Editor's Pick award is slightly more subjective, we confess, as compared to the other two awards.

VERDICT

The best performer award goes to the Toshiba Portégé Z30T-A. The pure CPU benchmarks did indicate below average performance, but overall, the Portégé pulled through with its stellar screen and excellent battery life, which matters more in this segment.

The Acer Aspire S7 deserves special mention for being almost as good, only losing out because the Portégé's screen and battery life were just a tiny bit better. The S7 does in fact, deserve an award for its form, which really is very impressive in a laptop. The very slim and sleek design

mean that you rarely feel like you're holding a full-fledged laptop in your hands and not some sort of tablet or Surface type device.

The Best Buy award goes to the Lenovo Ideapad Flex 2. It's the cheapest device in the test, but also the most powerful. We

would have definitely loved to see a more capable screen on the Flex, but if the Yoga's screen and hinge do not appeal, the Flex 2 is by far the better deal. It's a great all-rounder and that can hold its own with the best. The low battery life is still a major concern, but the Flex offers a lot for the price.

Finally, the Editor's Pick award goes to the Lenovo Yoga 2 13. Why? Because we feel that overall, it provides a more robust user experience compared to all the other Ultrabooks in this test. We do love the hinge and that screen needs to be seen to be believed. Picking between the Portégé, the S7 and the Yoga was really hard, but the Portégé was too expensive and the S7 was a little less ergonomic.

This has been among the toughest comparison test we've had to conduct, but hopefully, the effort has been worth it for you, as a consumer.



LENOVO

Ideapad Flex 2

PROS:

- Value for money
- Dedicated GPU
- Temperatures in check

CONS:

- Low contrast ratio (display)
- Sub-par white levels displayed
- Low battery life



TOSHIBA

Portégé Z30T-A

PROS:

- Excellent keyboard
- Vibrant screen
- Light-weight

CONS:

- Touchpad
- Touch-screen response
- Speaker Volume



LENOVO

Yoga 2 13

PROS:

- 360 degree hinge
- Bright and vibrant screen
- Ergonomics

CONS:

- Low battery life
- Bottom plate heats up
- Speaker volume